

**SIDE EVENT 1 — Better Analytics for Reduced Impact of Extreme Weather Events**  
**Hosted by KALRO / FAO Loss & Damage Project**  
**Wednesday, 17 June 2026 | 09:30–14:30 | In-Person**

**1. Overview**

This Side Event showcases analytical tools and modelling approaches developed under the KALRO–FAO Loss and Damage Project to quantify the impacts of extreme weather events on Kenya’s agricultural sector. It brings together researchers, policymakers, meteorological experts, and development partners to explore how advanced modelling can support climate-smart planning and reduce agricultural losses.

**2. Context & Rationale**

Kenya faces increasing exposure to droughts, floods, and climate-related shocks that undermine food security and livelihoods. Loss and damage assessments remain fragmented, limiting targeted interventions. The KALRO–FAO partnership has developed tools that quantify agricultural loss, assess vulnerability, and support evidence-based decision-making.

**3. Objectives**

- Present analytical tools developed to assess agricultural loss and damage caused by extreme weather events.
- Share results from modelling activities, including predicted impacts and vulnerability patterns.
- Facilitate dialogue among researchers, county governments, and climate institutions on the use of analytics for policy and planning.
- Identify opportunities for scaling evidence-based climate resilience strategies across Kenya.

**4. Key Topics**

Climate risk analytics; loss and damage methodologies; predictive modelling; integrating analytics into policy; strengthening climate data systems.

**5. Proposed Agenda**

Registration; Opening Remarks; Presentation of Tools & Results; Discussions; Way Forward.

**6. Expected Outcomes**

Improved understanding of climate analytics; evidence for policy recommendations; strengthened collaboration; clear next steps for integrating modelling tools into planning.

**SIDE EVENT 2 – AI in Agriculture: Opportunities, Implications & Risks**  
**Hosted by Strathmore Agri-Food Innovation Center (SAFIC)**  
**Wednesday, 17 June 2026 | 11:00–13:00 | Hybrid**

**1. Overview**

This Side Event explores the evolving role of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in transforming Kenya's agricultural sector. It highlights AI-enabled advisory systems, trusted agricultural content, and data governance frameworks that support climate-smart, farmer-centred transformation.

**2. Context & Rationale**

AI offers new opportunities for localized advisory services, predictive analytics, and decision support. However, concerns around trust, accuracy, and data governance remain. With strong research institutions and a vibrant agtech ecosystem, Kenya is well positioned to lead in responsible AI adoption.

**3. Objectives**

- ✓ Demystify AI for agricultural applications.
- ✓ Showcase existing AI-enabled advisory solutions.
- ✓ Explore partnerships for strengthening trusted agricultural content.
- ✓ Discuss governance and responsible data use.
- ✓ Identify collaboration opportunities across institutions.

**4. Key Topics**

AI-enabled advisory; trusted agricultural content; farmer-centred channels (WhatsApp, SMS, IVR); benchmarking AI models; data governance; cross-sector collaboration.

**5. Proposed Agenda**

Introductions; Opening Remarks; AI Advisory Presentation; Panel Discussion; Key Takeaways; Closing.

**6. Expected Outcomes**

Greater awareness of AI advisory work; clearer understanding of data governance; identified collaboration opportunities; shared priorities for strengthening farmer-centred AI systems.

## **SIDE EVENT 3 – Aflasafe Distributorship Business Session**

**Hosted by Kenya Agricultural & Livestock Research Organization (KALRO)**

**Wednesday, 17 June 2026 | 11:00–13:00 | In-Person**

### **1. Overview**

This Side Event focuses on strengthening Kenya’s capacity to scale Aflasafe, a biocontrol product that reduces aflatoxin contamination in maize and groundnuts. It brings together researchers, distributors, regulators, and development partners to explore business models and operational strategies for expanding Aflasafe distribution.

### **2. Context & Rationale**

Aflatoxin contamination threatens public health, market access, and farmer incomes. Aflasafe offers a proven solution, but its impact depends on effective distribution, market development, and last-mile delivery. KALRO’s research leadership provides a strong foundation for commercial scaling.

### **3. Objectives**

- ✓ Discuss the business case for Aflasafe distribution.
- ✓ Identify viable distributorship models.
- ✓ Strengthen linkages across research, private sector, and regulators.
- ✓ Explore market-driven adoption strategies.
- ✓ Share insights on demand, pricing, and delivery.

### **4. Key Topics**

Aflasafe technology; distribution models; market development; regulatory considerations; county partnerships; lessons from pilots.

### **5. Proposed Agenda**

Introductions; Opening Remarks; Aflasafe Technology Presentation; Panel Discussion; Key Takeaways.

### **6. Expected Outcomes**

Clear understanding of distributorship opportunities; strengthened partnerships; identified market gaps; agreed next steps for scaling Aflasafe adoption.

## **SIDE EVENT 4 – From Research to Impact: How KALRO & CIMMYT Are Advancing Agricultural Innovation**

**Hosted by CIMMYT in Partnership with KALRO**

**Wednesday, 17 June 2026 | 13:00–16:00 | In-Person**

### **1. Overview**

This Side Event highlights the long-standing partnership between KALRO and CIMMYT, showcasing collaborative research, field implementation, and capacity building that strengthen seed systems and deliver climate-resilient innovations to farmers. Presentations cover breeding, digital phenotyping, mechanization, conservation agriculture, and sustainable agrifood systems.

### **2. Context & Rationale**

Kenya's agriculture faces climate variability, soil degradation, pests, diseases, and limited access to quality seed. The KALRO–CIMMYT partnership addresses these challenges through innovations in breeding, seed systems, mechanization, climate-smart agronomy, and dryland crop improvement. The event aligns research priorities with Kenya's food security agenda.

### **3. Objectives**

- ✓ Highlight the strategic role of the KALRO–CIMMYT partnership.
- ✓ Showcase advances in breeding, seed systems, and climate-resilient crops.
- ✓ Share breakthroughs in mechanization, digital phenotyping, and field-trial excellence.
- ✓ Present innovations in soil health and sustainable agrifood systems.
- ✓ Strengthen collaboration across research, government, and private sector actors.

### **4. Key Topics**

Breeding operations; wheat and maize improvement; dryland crops; conservation agriculture; soil health; genetic resources and biodiversity.

### **5. Proposed Agenda**

Six technical sessions covering breeding, wheat, maize, dryland crops, sustainable agrifood systems, and genetic resources.

### **6. Expected Outcomes**

Strengthened collaboration; enhanced knowledge sharing; increased awareness of scalable innovations; clearer pathways for farmer adoption; alignment with national food security and climate resilience priorities.

## **SIDE EVENT 5 - Emerging Trends in Food Safety: Challenges, Innovations, Regulation & Policy**

**Hosted by KALRO, Egerton University & IITA**

**Wednesday, 17 June 2026 | 14:00–17:00 | Hybrid**

### **1. Overview**

This Side Event brings together researchers, regulators, industry actors, and development partners to examine emerging food safety challenges and innovations. It explores detection technologies, regulatory frameworks, and opportunities for strengthening collaboration to build a safer, more resilient food system.

### **2. Context & Rationale**

Food safety remains a major public health and economic concern in Kenya, with risks from aflatoxins, pathogens, chemical residues, and poor post-harvest handling. New technologies—rapid diagnostics, digital traceability, improved processing—offer pathways for improvement. KALRO and Egerton play key roles in generating evidence and informing policy.

### **3. Objectives**

- ✓ Highlight emerging food safety challenges affecting Kenya’s food and agricultural systems.
- ✓ Showcase innovations in food safety research, diagnostics, and mitigation.
- ✓ Strengthen understanding of regulatory and policy frameworks governing food safety.
- ✓ Facilitate dialogue between researchers, regulators, and industry actors.
- ✓ Identify collaboration opportunities for improved compliance and consumer protection.

### **4. Key Topics**

Food safety risks; detection and diagnostics; regulatory frameworks; industry compliance; research–policy–industry collaboration; capacity strengthening.

### **5. Proposed Agenda**

Opening; Presentations on challenges and innovations; Regulatory perspectives; Panel discussion; Q&A; Closing.

### **6. Expected Outcomes**

Improved understanding of risks and innovations; alignment between research and regulation; identification of policy gaps; strengthened collaboration; clear next steps for enhancing Kenya’s food safety systems.

## **SIDE EVENT 6 – Sustainable Livestock in Kenya: Unlocking Economic, Environmental & Social Benefits**

**Hosted by the International Livestock Research Institute (ILRI)**

**Thursday, 18 June 2026 | 09:00–11:00 | In-Person**

### **1. Overview**

This Side Event highlights the role of livestock systems in Kenya's economy, environment, and social wellbeing. It showcases ILRI's co-created solutions for sustainable rangeland management, dairy development, gender-responsive livestock enterprises, and climate-smart livestock systems.

### **2. Context & Rationale**

Livestock contributes significantly to household incomes and national GDP but faces pressures from climate change, rangeland degradation, feed scarcity, gender inequities, and limited market access. ILRI's research with KALRO provides actionable solutions that enhance productivity, resilience, and sustainability.

### **3. Objectives**

- ✓ Share interventions that unlock livestock economic, environmental, and social benefits.
- ✓ Present evidence-based solutions for sustainable rangeland management, dairy development, and women-led livestock enterprises.
- ✓ Facilitate dialogue on scaling livestock innovations.
- ✓ Strengthen collaboration for priority climate-smart livestock systems

### **4. Key Topics**

Sustainable rangeland management; dairy value chain innovations; women-led livestock businesses; co-creation with communities; research-driven sustainability approaches.

### **5. Proposed Agenda**

Opening; Technical presentations; Panel discussion; Q&A; Closing remarks.

### **6. Expected Outcomes**

Strengthened collaboration; increased awareness of sustainable livestock interventions; clearer scaling pathways; alignment with policy and community needs; shared priorities for climate-smart livestock development.

**SIDE EVENT 7 – Accelerating Sustainable Production, Market Trade & Consumption**  
**Hosted by the Alliance of Bioversity International & CIAT (Co-hosted with KALRO)**  
**Thursday, 18 June 2026 | 10:00–12:30 | In-Person**

**1. Overview**

This Side Event presents an integrated *genes-to-markets* model linking climate-resilient varieties, regenerative agriculture, soil health, digital innovation, and market-driven consumption. It draws on 30 years of Alliance/CIAT–KALRO partnership through PABRA to demonstrate how coordinated action across genetics, agronomy, markets, and consumer behaviour can transform Kenya’s bean value chain.

.

**2. Context & Rationale**

Kenya’s agri-food systems face climate variability, soil degradation, low productivity, and weak market integration. Beans hold major potential for nutrition and income, yet production gaps and limited market linkages persist. The corridor approach aligns genetics, agronomy, markets, and consumption to unlock this potential and drive sustainable scaling.

**3. Objectives**

- ✓ Present the production corridor model
- ✓ Showcase 30 years of ABC/PABRA–KALRO partnership impact.
- ✓ Highlight circularity and regenerative agriculture practices that unlock genetic potential.
- ✓ Explore urban market opportunities.
- ✓ Share evidence on soil health, digital innovation, and on-farm testing platforms.
- ✓ Catalyse partnerships and resource mobilization to close production and market gaps.

**4. Key Topics**

Demand-led breeding; seed systems; production corridors; regenerative agriculture; urban markets; digital agronomy; market linkages.

**5. Proposed Agenda**

Welcome; Four technical presentations; Panel discussion; Open Q&A.

**6. Expected Outcomes**

Clear understanding of the corridor model; identified priority actions; strengthened partnerships across research, government, private sector, and development partners.

## **SIDE EVENT 8 – Cassava Starch Processing: Which Way Forward?**

**Hosted by KALRO & Agriculture and Food Authority (AFA)**

**Thursday, 18 June 2026 | 11:00–13:00 | Hybrid**

### **1. Overview**

This Side Event examines the future of cassava starch processing in Kenya, focusing on market opportunities, industrial demand, farmer supply systems, and the enabling environment required to unlock sector growth. It brings together researchers, processors, regulators, private sector actors, and farmer organizations to explore viable business models and investment pathways.

### **2. Context & Rationale**

Cassava is a strategic crop for food security, climate resilience, and industrial development. Demand for cassava starch is rising across food, textile, pharmaceutical, adhesive, and paper industries. However, Kenya's production and processing capacity remain insufficient, with challenges in raw material supply, technology, quality standards, and market linkages.

### **3. Objectives**

- ✓ Examine the current status of cassava starch processing in Kenya.
- ✓ Identify market opportunities and industrial demand drivers.
- ✓ Discuss supply chain challenges and strategies for strengthening farmer–processor linkages.
- ✓ Explore investment opportunities and viable business models for processors.
- ✓ Align stakeholders on policy, standards, and regulatory requirements.
- ✓ Define actionable next steps for scaling cassava starch production sustainably.

### **4. Key Topics**

Market trends; industrial applications; supply systems; processing technologies; quality standards; pricing and competitiveness; policy and regulatory considerations.

### **5. Proposed Agenda**

Opening; Cassava Starch Landscape Presentation; Panel Discussion; Key Takeaways.

### **6. Expected Outcomes**

Clear understanding of market potential; identified value chain gaps; strengthened collaboration; agreed priority actions for scaling processing capacity; alignment with national food security and industrialization goals.



**SIDE EVENT 9 – Business Session: ECF Vaccine Commercialization**  
**Hosted by KALRO – Veterinary Sciences Research Institute (VSRI)**  
**Thursday, 18 June 2026 | 14:00–16:00 | Hybrid**

**1. Overview**

This Business Session advances the commercialization pathway for the East Coast Fever (ECF) vaccine, focusing on the locally produced Marikebuni vaccine. It brings together regulators, private sector actors, researchers, and development partners to review regulatory compliance, production readiness, market expansion, and partnership models.

**2. Context & Rationale**

ECF remains one of the most economically damaging livestock diseases in Eastern Africa. Kenya relies on two vaccines: the imported Muguga Cocktail and the locally produced Marikebuni vaccine. Commercialization has been slowed by incomplete registration dossiers, GMP requirements, limited production volumes, weak distribution systems, and low farmer awareness. This session aligns stakeholders around a coordinated commercialization roadmap.

**3. Objectives**

- ✓ Review progress toward **regulatory approval** and completion of the registration dossier.
- ✓ Discuss **GMP requirements** and pathways for certification.
- ✓ Explore **public–private partnership models** for production scale-up and distribution.
- ✓ Identify market opportunities and strategies for expanding national and regional uptake.
- ✓ Agree on priority actions and responsibilities ahead of the KALRO Scientific Conference and Innovation Expo 2026.

**4. Key Topics**

Regulatory and GMP requirements; production capacity; market demand; distribution models; private sector engagement; commercialization roadmap.

**5. Proposed Agenda**

Opening; Regulatory & GMP Presentation; Market & Distribution Presentation; Panel Discussion; Key Takeaways.

**6. Expected Outcomes**

Clear understanding of regulatory requirements; agreed next steps for dossier completion; strengthened partnerships; identified market expansion opportunities; coordinated commercialization roadmap.

## **SIDE EVENT 10 – Tsetse Repellent Business Session & Official Launch**

**Hosted by KALRO**

**Wednesday, 16 June 2026 | Hybrid**

### **Overview**

This Business Session and official launch presents KALRO's breakthrough Tsetse Repellent Technology for both humans and animals. The session highlights the product's efficacy, regulatory milestones, commercial readiness, and strong demand from wildlife authorities, pastoral communities, and regional governments. It provides a platform for validating market demand and engaging potential industrial partners for production scale-up.

### **Context & Rationale**

Tsetse flies cause significant economic losses through trypanosomiasis in livestock and humans. KALRO's patented repellent and attractant technologies have undergone extensive validation, with strong interest from Kenya Wildlife Service, Serengeti National Park (Safari-Cham), Kidepo Valley Park, and the Government of Tanzania. Commercialization has been slowed only by market demand quantification, the final requirement for industrial investment and large-scale production.

### **Objectives**

- ✓ Officially launch the Tsetse Repellent for human and animal use (Tuesday 16th June).
- ✓ Present efficacy results, regulatory approvals, and commercialization readiness.
- ✓ Validate market demand with key stakeholders.
- ✓ Engage potential industrial partners and distributors.
- ✓ Agree on next steps for production scale-up and deployment.

### **Key Topics**

Efficacy validation; patents and regulatory approvals; commercial trials; demand quantification; production pathways; partnership opportunities.

### **Agenda**

Launch Ceremony (Tuesday). Wednesday: Technical Presentation; Market Demand Discussion; Partner Engagement; Next Steps.

### **Expected Outcomes**

Validated demand; strengthened partnerships; clarity on production strategy; commitments for pilot purchases; positioning of the repellent as a flagship KALRO commercialization success.

## **SIDE EVENT 11 — Delivering Biotechnology in Kenya: Delivery, Products & Future Prospects**

**Hosted by KALRO – Biotechnology Research Institute (BioRI) & AATF**

**18 June 2026 | Hybrid | In-Person & Virtual**

### **Overview**

This Side Event brings together biotechnology researchers, policymakers, industry actors, farmers, and media to explore Kenya's progress in delivering modern biotechnology solutions for agriculture. The session highlights practical experiences in deploying biotechnology innovations, emerging breeding techniques, regulatory developments, and the future of modern biotechnology products in strengthening climate-smart agriculture and national food security.

### **Context & Rationale**

Biotechnology offers transformative solutions to Kenya's agricultural challenges, including climate change, pests and diseases, low productivity, and food insecurity. Kenya has made significant progress in research, regulatory reforms, and product development, yet awareness gaps, policy uncertainties, and limited public understanding continue to slow adoption. This Side Event provides a platform to share lessons learned, showcase ongoing innovations, and discuss how modern biotechnology can unlock economic, environmental, and social benefits for the country.

### **Objectives**

- Share Kenya's experience in delivering biotechnology innovations.
- Highlight opportunities, challenges, and lessons learned in biotechnology deployment.
- Explore emerging breeding techniques and regional progress.
- Discuss future prospects of modern biotechnology products for Kenya.
- Identify strategic actions, partnerships, and policy recommendations.

### **Key Topics**

Biotechnology delivery pathways; emerging breeding techniques; regional data-driven decision-making; modern biotech products; regulatory and policy considerations; awareness creation; commercialization pathways.

### **Agenda**

Registration; Opening Remarks & Presentation; Panel Discussion; Q&A; Closing Remarks.

### **Expected Outcomes**

- Increased awareness and understanding of modern biotechnology.
- Clear lessons on delivering biotechnology in Kenya.
- Identification of strategic actions and partnerships.
- Recommendations for policy briefs and future collaboration.
- Strengthened alignment between research, regulation, and public engagement.